The Army has Corps and Areas, both commanded by Lt Gens. and subordinate to Command HQ. Whereas Corps have an operational role, Areas are more focused on administration. The Areas and the Sub-Areas that fall under it form an administrative grid on which the field army rides. 2 Corps at Ambala, for example, in times of war would mobilize and get deployed anywhere in Punjab. They could not possibly be looking over their shoulder for their requirements of daily maintenance, which would be the function of the Area or Sub-Area it was dependent on. It is an important function, of which most people, even those in uniform, are unaware. Moreover, being purely administrative assignments, postings to the Area or Sub-Area are considered to be dead-end postings with no future career prospects, which is not really so.

Unlike other Area HQs, which have Sub-Areas under them, Delhi Area is a stand-alone Area looking after all the administrative aspects in the entire Delhi NCR. The housing needs of all personnel posted in Delhi, including the provision of essential services such as water and electricity, are met by Delhi Area. It is a humongous task; there are no fewer than ninety married-accommodation colonies for officers and JCOs/OR, catering to more than 22,000 married personnel and approximately 40,000 or so personnel staying in the units in Other Than Married (OTM) accommodation. All this existing infrastructure requires periodic maintenance to keep it habitable and there is a dedicated budget of approximately Rs 330–350 crore per year. Budgets are always finite and one has to juggle between different priorities. Water availability remains a challenge and contracts have to be negotiated with the Delhi Jal Board to get as much water released as possible. New civil works have to be initiated at an average of Rs 200–300 crore per annum and those in progress monitored for quality of construction. It

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